

packs, however, if you use a third-party launcher, this will be easier. Consider using launchers with a built-in icon pack or theme support. Another method that doesn't involve installing launchers is using the Shortcut Maker app on Android. Now, install an icon pack that you would like to use. Next, choose the app you want to change the icon of in the Shortcuts app and then tap the Icon section to apply a supported icon from the pack you downloaded.



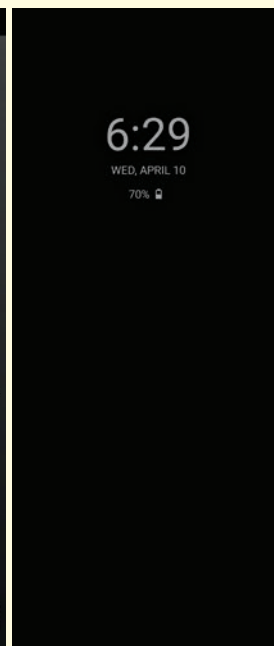
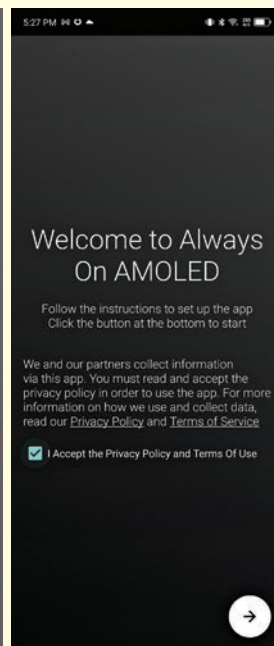
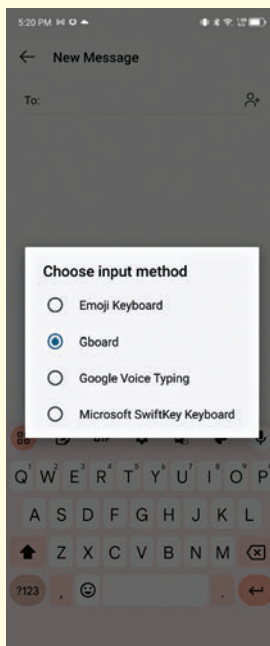
Switch up your default keyboard

Devices running a custom skin on top of Android usually default to the manufacturer's keyboard or others such as SwiftKey. If you're someone who prefers another keyboard such as Google's well-regarded GBoard, you could switch to it with relative ease. On Android, when you change the keyboard, the system applies the change across the board. To change the keyboard on your Android device, download the keyboard app you want from the Google Play Store. Upon opening the app, chances are it will automatically give you the prompt to switch your keyboard, which you can agree to. If it doesn't, simply head to Settings > System > Languages & Input > On-Screen Keyboard. Now, toggle the default keyboard off, toggle on the one you have just downloaded and then click OK. For example, I have downloaded both GBoard and SwiftKey on this Tecno phone as shown in the image below and replaced it with Tecno's default 'Emoji Keyboard'.



Activate the Always-On display

Several phones on the market today come with an Always-On display. While the AOD does deplete your battery, features such as LTPO displays and Adaptive refresh rate decrease the rate of battery depletion. An Always-On display can provide you with important information such as notifications, time, date, weather, and more at a glance. All without having to check



the lock screen or the home screen. You can search your phone's settings for the Always-On display and use the one that works best for you. If your phone doesn't have the AOD functionality, you can download the Always On AMOLED app from the Play Store. The app needs a few permissions but it can provide you with a functional AOD complete with the time, date, battery percentage, notification icons, and even music playback. Do note that this app has some ads and a couple of features behind a paywall.

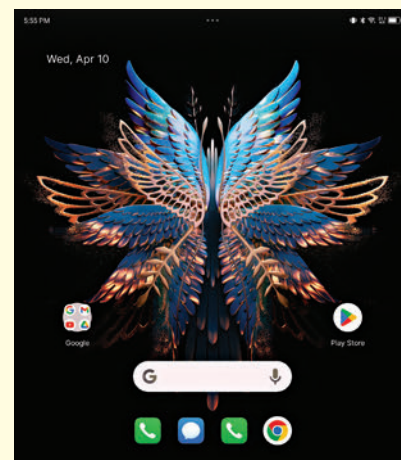


Play around with launchers

Launchers have been the bread and butter of Android customisation for more than a decade now. A launcher overhauls the design language of your phone's UI and some of these also provide extra features that you don't get on your phone's default skin. There are countless third-party launchers on Google's Play Store that you can play around with. Some of the most popular launchers are:

- **Nova Launcher** - known for customisability and speed
- **Niagara Launcher** - known for being lean and keeping distractions to a minimum

- **Smart Launcher 6** - known for its adaptability and simplified layout
- **Action Launcher** - known for its customisation and gesture options
- **Pixel Launcher** - known for its Stock Android interface



Root your phone

Rooting your phone can be an intimidating process but it rids the phone of many of its restrictions. You can remove uninstallable bloatware, overclock your phone, get access to specialised settings and system files, install custom ROMs, and much more. However, there are risks associated with this and there is a chance you may brick your phone, so only proceed with